Skilled Independent visa (subclass 189)

New Zealand stream

This visa lets eligible New Zealand citizens who have demonstrated commitment and contribution to Australia, live and work in Australia permanently.

About this visa

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With this visa you can

- stay in Australia indefinitely
- work and study in Australia
- enrol in Australia's public health care scheme, Medicare *(http://www.humanservices.gov.au/individuals/medicare)*
- sponsor your relatives to come to Australia
- travel to and from Australia for 5 years
- if eligible, become an Australian citizen *(/citizenship/become-a-citizen)*

Newly arrived residents may have to wait before they can access certain Australian Government payments and benefits *(https://www.humanservices.gov.au/individuals/enablers/newly-arrived-residents-waiting-period)*.

How long you can stay

Ask a question

This is a permanent visa. It lets you stay in Australia indefinitely. The visa has a travel component that expires 5 years after the date we grant you the visa.

For information about citizenship see Become an Australian citizen (by conferral) Permanent residents or eligible New Zealand citizens *(/citizenship/become-a-citizen/permanent-resident)*.

Include family

You can include members of the family unit in your application. You can:

- include them when you lodge your visa application
- add them after you lodge your application but before we decide on your visa.

Family members who apply for the visa must meet our health *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health)* and character *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/character)* requirements.

If your partner or dependent children are not included in this application, tell us the reason why (for example, they already hold Australian citizenship or are a permanent resident).

Cost

The subclass 189 visa in the New Zealand stream is closed to new applications.

There is also a charge for each family member who applies for the visa with you.

The visa application charges are paid in two instalments. The first instalment is 20% of the total visa application charge payable at time of lodgement. The second instalment is the remaining 80% of the visa application charge. The second charge must be paid before we grant you your visa.

To work out what your visa will cost use the Visa Pricing Estimator *(/visas/visa-pricing-estimator?visa=189-62)*.

You might also have to pay other costs for health checks, police certificates and biometrics.

Apply from

You must be in Australia and holding a Subclass 444 visa when you apply for the visa.

Any family members included in your application can be in or outside of Australia when you apply. However, if they are in Australia, they must hold a substantive visa or bridging A, B or C visa.

Processing times

For an indication of processing times for this visa, use the visa processing time guide tool *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-processing-times/global-visa-processing-times)*. This will show the processing times for recently decided applications. It is a guide only and not specific to your application.

We assess applications on a case-by-case basis, and actual processing times can vary due to individual circumstances including:

- whether you have lodged a complete application, including all necessary supporting documents

- how quickly you respond to any requests for additional information
- how long it takes to perform required checks on the supporting information provided
- how long it takes to receive additional information from external agencies, particularly in relation to health, character, and national security requirements
- for permanent migration visa applications, how many places are available in the migration program

Your obligations

You and your family members must obey all Australian laws.

Travel

You can travel in and out of Australia as many times as you want for 5 years from the date we grant the visa. After 5 years you will need a Resident Return (RRV) visa (subclass 155 or 157) *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/resident-return-visa-155-157)* to re-enter Australia as a permanent resident.

Visa label

We will digitally link your visa to your passport. You will not get a label in your passport.

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